CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 2

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A reader concludes that the nest on the Padma was 'perhaps the last in Bangladesh'. This tells us the species there was: 1

(a) close to disappearing **(b)** well protected
(c) growing fast **(d)** very common

2. The elephant's list of human qualities is meant to suggest that humans are: 1

(a) capable of both great good and great harm
(b) unknowable
(c) always wise
(d) always wicked

3. Which detail best hints at the later twist? 1

(a) the colour of the lifeboat
(b) the ship's name
(c) the time of boarding
(d) the men's pleased smiles when the clicking is heard

4. The adjective 'dank' tells the reader that the marsh is: 1

(a) cold and unpleasantly wet **(b)** clean and fresh
(c) bright and sunny **(d)** dry and dusty

5. Morocco's reading of the gold inscription shows that he: 1

(a) chose at random **(b)** distrusted Portia
(c) equated Portia with what many men desire **(d)** ignored the words

6. Two of seven released gharials survived. The survival share is about: 1

(a) 10 per cent **(b)** 29 per cent **(c)** 71 per cent **(d)** 50 per cent

7. Which statement is an opinion about the poem? 1

(a) It mentions a reservoir.
(b) It is the best poem about nature ever written.
(c) It is by Vikram Seth.
(d) It features an elephant.

8. Which is the best moral of the story? 1

(a) Do not draw conclusions from partial evidence.
(b) Trust no one.
(c) Avoid pigeons.
(d) Never travel by ship.

9. The poem reaches its quietest point in: 1

(a) the first line **(b)** the lizard line
(c) the line about gold cups **(d)** the final couplet

10. The ring is important to the plot because it is: 1

(a) a form of payment **(b)** a pledge that must not be given away
(c) a gift for Morocco **(d)** a prize for Arragon

11. Which of these would the author most likely support? 1

(a) closing all zoos immediately **(b)** banning all research
(c) removing gharials from all rivers **(d)** river protection involving local people

12. Which sentence is correct in grammar? 1

(a) The animals which lives in the forest was worried.
(b) The animals who living in forest worried.
(c) Animals the worried lived forest.
(d) The animals, who lived in the forest, were worried.

13. What does the narrator's relief at the end suggest? 1

(a) he did not care **(b)** he planned the joke
(c) he knew all along **(d)** he was truly afraid for lives

14. Which statement about the poem is correct? 1

(a) It praises a city.
(b) It states a moral lesson in the last line.
(c) It tells a story with dialogue.
(d) It appeals more to sight than to other senses.

15. Which sentence is in the passive voice? 1

(a) Bassanio chose the lead casket. **(b)** Portia loved Bassanio.
(c) The lead casket was chosen by Bassanio. **(d)** Morocco left Belmont.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. Why might local fishers be important partners in gharial conservation? 2

17. Why is the elephant a reliable speaker? 2

18. Why is the narrator's fear of ridicule important to the plot? 2

19. How is twilight made to seem alive? 2

20. Why does Portia keep her father's rule although she loves Bassanio? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. How does the story use contrast? 3

INTERMIND

22. What does the poem suggest about the marsh as a living place? 3

23. Evaluate Portia's role in a plot she cannot control. 3

24. Write a slogan and explain it: for saving the gharial. 3

OR

Combine: 'The road came. The forest vanished.' 3

25. Suggest how the ending could be altered for a serious tone. 3

OR

Compare how the cranes' flight and the vapours' movement are shown. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. 'Wisdom lies in looking beyond appearances.' Discuss with reference to the story. 5

OR

Write a letter to the editor urging protection of river sand banks. 5

27. Imagine you are the tragopan. Write a diary entry after hearing the elephant's warning. 5

OR

Write a short speech on 'Think before you act', using the story. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND